



A Hands-on Review of ICS on Galaxy SII

This is a first-hand review of Android Ice Cream Sandwich (ICS) running on a Samsung Galaxy SII. While ICS lets you browse faster and helps you unlock your device using facial recognition, it also comes with a few drawbacks. Read on to know more...

For a long time, we Androidians kept hearing about the coolness of Google's Android Ice Cream Sandwich. Much before it was rolled out to the masses, the phone was garnering accolades and awards, and was even voted the 'Phone of the Year' by T3 Gadgets. Well, I was fortunate enough to be among the first to have it working on my Galaxy SII. Here are my experiences...

As soon as you upgrade your phone with ICS, you can feel the difference immediately, right after turning on your mobile device. It configures all the applications, contacts and a lot more, in a jiffy. And once you get to the home screen, you will see a remarkable difference in speed—it's cool and fast. But do not expect the original interface of ICS (like you see on the Google Nexus), so unfortunately, there are no virtual buttons. This version of ICS is garnished by the Samsung Touchwiz 4.0. Like it or hate it, you have to live with it.

Besides the speed-up, till date I haven't even once faced any hanging issues. That's stability indeed!

The changes in looks and the menu include:

- You will find some new options, like 'Restart', in the menu, when you long-press the power button.

- Screen-shots are now officially taken by 'Vol Down + Power Button'. The default location where shots are saved has changed to `/sdcard/pictures/screenshots`.
- The Settings menu has also undergone a revamp, with the menu categorised for easy scrolling.

Scrolling

- Touchwiz replaces the Apple-patented bounce effect (while going up and down the scrolling menu) with blue illumination that lights up once you reach the end of the menu.
- The home screen now wraps around—you can scroll from the last screen onward to the first, without having to move backwards from the last screen.

Face-recognition-based unlocking

- This feature is one of the highlights of the new OS. It immediately unlocks your device, unless you choose to try it from a distance, which takes longer for the device to recognise you.

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